JULIAN TSANG

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, USA · *Non-degree coursework* Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Analysis in $\mathbb{R}^n$ I: A; ranked 1st in the final exam (77/80) among 30 students

University of Oxford, UK · *MPhil in Economics* Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Graduated with *Distinction* (US GPA equivalent: 4.0/4.0)
- Relevant courses (70+ is Distinction level): Core Microeconomics (82/100), Core Econometrics (73/100), Core Macroeconomics (70/100), and Advanced Econometrics (73/100), a PhD-level course covering asymptotics and measure theory
- Thesis: "Patronage or Purge? The Economic Impact of Elite Connections in China's Leadership Transition" (supervised by Prof. Noam Yuchtman)

University College London, UK · *BSc Economics* Sep 2020 – Jun 2023

- Graduated with *First Class Honours*, ranked 30th of 499 (top 6%); average of 76/100 (US GPA equivalent: 4.0/4.0)
- Relevant courses: Statistical Methods in Economics (94/100), Mathematics for Economics (86/100), Economics of Finance (88/100), and Economics of Financial Markets (80/100)

RESEARCH

"Process Efficiency as a Barrier to Innovation" · *Working paper* 2026

- Built a dynamic model in which firms split their R&D between *product innovation*, which generates patents, and *process efficiency*, which lowers costs on every product line a firm operates and so pays off most for large firms
- The model predicts that R&D subsidies to large firms disproportionately fund process efficiency and crowd out patenting by smaller firms. Found support for this prediction in firm-level data from the Chinese Tax Survey, with results robust to a shift-share instrument based on provincial patterns in subsidy allocation
- Calibrated to the Chinese economy, the model implies that the current subsidies reduce welfare, while shifting the same budget from incumbents to entrants would raise consumption-equivalent welfare by 10.7%

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Professional, Becker Friedman Institute · *University of Chicago* Jul 2025 – Present

- Worked with Profs. Rossi-Hansberg and Hsieh to build a general-equilibrium model of how superstar firms emerge, where firms grow by improving their products and by taking over product lines from one another
- In the model, firms with lower production costs can win product lines even with inferior products, so they can become superstars while aggregate growth declines
- Wrote code to solve and simulate the model and calibrated it to the U.S., Indian, and Mexican economies. Used it to ask whether taxing one type of firm to subsidize the other can raise growth
- Extended the spatial integrated assessment model of Cruz and Rossi-Hansberg (2024) to include a collapse of the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation, and used an extension of Desmet et al. (2025) to predict long-run income convergence across space
- Assisted with the revise-and-resubmit of "Local GDP Estimates Around the World" (Rossi-Hansberg and Zhang, 2026), leading to its acceptance by the *Journal of Urban Economics*. Designed its uncertainty measures

Research Assistant to Prof. Shaoda Wang · *University of Chicago* Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Used LLMs to construct sentiment scores from over 150 million social media posts by entrepreneurs, for a project on how government arrests in China affect entrepreneur sentiment and firm financial outcomes

Research Assistant to Prof. David Yang · *Harvard University* Apr 2024 – Feb 2025

- Contributed to a study of the government-guided investment funds through which China channels state capital into targeted industries, collecting the funds' policy documents and using LLMs to code their investment mandates
- Used LLMs to measure the industrial policy focus of Chinese regional governments from their annual reports and five-year plans

Research Assistant to Prof. Andrea Bernini · *University of Oxford* Jan 2024 – Sep 2024

- Contributed to the revise-and-resubmit of a paper on NAFTA's effect on income inequality in Mexico, addressing the referees' concerns about its identification strategy
- Wrote a section of a paper on the 1990 German reunification and gender differences in smoking in East Germany

OTHER EXPERIENCE

RBB Economics (economic consultancy), London, UK · *Intern* Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

- Worked on a UK steel merger, cleaning sales data to show the closeness of competition between the merging parties in response to information requests from the Competition and Markets Authority

Capital Pilot (venture capital firm), London, UK · *Consultant* Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

- Assessed over 150 early-stage startups from their pitch decks and financial models, evaluating market opportunity, product differentiation, traction, and execution
- Developed metrics adopted in the firm's rating system, which guided the £5M Boost Fund's first-round investments

Equinix (global data center provider), Hong Kong SAR · *Intern* Jun 2022 – Sep 2022

- Built Excel and Tableau tools to forecast sales from historical deal data and presented them to APAC analysts

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

UCL Mahjong Society, London, UK · *President* Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

- Organized weekly sessions introducing the East Asian game to members and explaining its rules to beginners
- Launched the first London inter-university mahjong contest, organized jointly with LSE, KCL, and Imperial

UCL Data Science Society, London, UK · *Quantitative Researcher* Oct 2021 – Jun 2022

- Organized workshops on the basics of econometrics and machine learning, including OLS, LASSO, and random forests
- Led a team of student researchers in designing algorithmic trading strategies, guiding them through collecting the data, backtesting the strategies, and publishing the results

UCL Investment Fund, London, UK · *Researcher* Apr 2021 – Jun 2022

- Co-authored a report on the earnings announcement premium, backtesting the anomaly on S&P 500 firms and examining retail trading as a possible explanation

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Distinction, MPhil in Economics (University of Oxford, 2025)
- First Class Honours, BSc Economics (University College London, 2023)
- Finalist, UCL Explore Econ research competition (2022 and 2023)
- A* in all four International A-Levels (Highest Mark in the World for Economics, 2020)
- Second Place, Hong Kong Inter-School Economic Analysis Competition (Hong Kong Association for Economics Education, 2020)

REFERENCES

Prof. Esteban Rossi-Hansberg
Glen A. Lloyd Distinguished Service Professor
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
University of Chicago
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Prof. Chang-Tai Hsieh
Phyllis and Irwin Winkelried Distinguished Service Professor of Economics
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Prof. Klaus Desmet
Ruth and Kenneth Altshuler Centennial Interdisciplinary Professor of Economics
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Prof. Juanma Castro-Vincenzi
Assistant Professor
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
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MISCELLANEOUS

- **Programming:** MATLAB, Python, Julia, R, Stata, Dynare, ArcGIS, and LaTeX
- **CFA Program:** Passed Level I
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Cantonese (native), and Mandarin
- **Interests:** Tennis, Climbing, Volunteering, and Traveling to Ethnic Minority Areas in China